



TRAINING PART 1: CHARACTER CREATION



WELCOME TO SKYRIM



We have designed the Character Creation section of the “Training” chapter to give you tactical advice in the same order as you make decisions while adventuring across the wilds of Skyrim. To begin with, we reveal the benefits of choosing a particular race. Then we thoroughly explore all 18 of the skills—and the perks associated with each—so you know what each skill does, how you increase it, and what perks to select based on your play style. Finally, we present a host of Character Archetypes—exceptional explorers tailored to a specific role, renowned heroes who use the best combinations of skills and equipment to suit a particular play style.



TIP Please read through the game’s Instruction Manual and familiarize yourself with the tenets of this adventure. This training chapter assumes you have already read this information.

This guide encompasses all of Skyrim’s original content and updates, as well as the Dawnguard, Hearthfire, and Dragonborn add-ons. The following icons are used to indicate new material related to an update or add-on:



Content associated with this icon is primarily related to the Dawnguard expansion.



Content associated with this icon is primarily related to the Hearthfire expansion.



Content associated with this icon is primarily related to the Dragonborn expansion.



Content associated with this icon was added or changed by a game update.

Look for these four icons throughout this book so you know what’s new.



SELECTING A RACE



PART I: THE RACES OF SKYRIM



As you begin your adventure across Skyrim, the historic Elder Scrolls mantra “you are what you play” rings true: Although statistically, an Orc Wizard or a High Elven Thief may not be the optimal character choices based on starting skill bonuses and racial powers, this doesn’t matter in the long run. Choose the race that most appeals to you, and don’t worry about statistics and abilities.

You can overcome low starting skill values by using the skills in which you wish to become more proficient. No races have any intrinsic shortfalls that will prevent you from becoming the type of hero you want to be.

However, there are certain advantages to picking a particular race. For those adventurers who wish to maximize every advantage, it is useful to know which favored skills each race begins with bonuses to, and to understand the unique racial powers they possess; this can aid you when choosing a particular play style.

In short, this section reveals which races are best suited to a particular style of adventuring, whether that be with melee weapons, magic, stealth, or some combination of these styles.

Racial Skill Advantages

The following table shows the starting skill statistics for each race. The higher the number (over the base level of 15), the better. Values of 20 indicate this is a favored skill of the race. Values of 25 indicate this is a primary skill of the race.

RACE	SMITHING	HEAVY ARMOR	BLOCK	TWO-HANDED	ONE-HANDED	ARCHERY	LIGHT ARMOR	SNEAK	LOCKPICKING	PICKPOCKET	SPEECH	ALCHEMY	ILLUSION	CONJURATION	DESTRUCTION	RESTORATION	ALTERATION	ENCHANTING
Argonian	15	15	15	15	15	15	20	20	25	20	15	15	15	15	15	20	20	15
Breton	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	20	20	20	25	15	20	20	15
Dark Elf	15	15	15	15	15	15	20	20	15	15	15	20	20	15	25	15	20	15
High Elf	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	25	20	20	20	20	20
Imperial	15	20	20	15	20	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	20	25	15	20
Khajiit	15	15	15	15	20	20	15	25	20	20	15	20	15	15	15	15	15	15
Nord	20	15	20	25	20	15	20	15	15	15	20	15	15	15	15	15	15	15
Orc	20	25	20	20	20	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	20
Redguard	20	15	20	15	25	20	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	20	15	20	15
Wood Elf	15	15	15	15	15	25	20	20	20	20	15	20	15	15	15	15	15	15



NOTE For example, if you chose a Khajiit character, you’d receive a +5 bonus to your One-Handed, Archery, Lockpicking, Pickpocket, and Alchemy and a +10 to your Sneak skill.

Notes on Gender: There are no differences between the genders of a particular race; they share the same set of starting skill values, spells, powers, and abilities. Feel free to create the character that most appeals to you without penalty.



Starting Spells, Racial Powers, and Abilities

In addition to a slight boost to the base value of certain skills, each race has its own set of starting Spells; Racial Powers that offer a unique bonus such as the ability to regenerate or absorb Magicka; and innate Racial Abilities, such as a resistance to Frost damage. A tactical overview of each race follows.

NOTE Racial Commentary: The race you choose will affect the greetings and passing comments the citizens of Skyrim make when you speak to or pass by them.

Races and Gameplay: Very rarely, your race may also have a small effect on gameplay. For example:

When infiltrating the Thalmor Embassy dressed in the robes of that High Elf faction, High Elves (and to a lesser extent other Elves) will find it easier to sneak around undetected than will members of the other races.

Orcs are welcome in Skyrim's Orc strongholds, while members of other races must first prove themselves worthy.

The tone and color of some dialogue choices may change depending on your race and the situation.

If your race has a noticeable effect on an interaction, that will be noted when relevant. But this isn't something to be concerned about: nothing is closed to you because of your race; indeed, you may be surprised by a positive benefit when you least expect it!

Argonians

Favored Skills: +10 Lockpicking, +5 Pickpocket, Sneak, Light Armor, Alteration, Restoration

Starting Spells: Flames, Healing

Racial Power—Histskin: You regenerate health 10x faster for 60 seconds

Racial Abilities: 50% Disease Resistance, Underwater Breathing

Ideal Play Style: Thief (Defensive)



A male Argonian

A female Argonian

Little is known about the reptilian denizens of Black Marsh. Years of defending their borders have made the Argonians experts in guerilla warfare, and their natural abilities make them equally at home in water and on land. They are well suited for the treacherous swamps of their homeland and have developed natural immunity to the diseases that have doomed many would-be explorers in the region.

TIP Histskin is a fantastic ability for any character, capable of quickly bringing you back from the brink of death. Even better, as a power, it allows you to keep attacking while it does its work—no concentration required.

Resist Disease reduces the chance that you'll contract a disease from an animal or trap; it doesn't affect the severity of any diseases you might already have. Diseases are rarely a significant threat in Skyrim, although they can be debilitating if you let them pile up. Visit a shrine periodically, and you shouldn't have any trouble.

Underwater Breathing means you'll never have to worry about drowning damage. Diving is rarely required, but this ability may allow you to claim the occasional sunken treasure or explore shipwrecks more easily.

Breton

Favored Skills: +10 Conjuration, +5 Illusion, Restoration, Speech, Alchemy, Alteration

Starting Spells: Flames, Healing, Conjure Familiar

Racial Power—Dragonskin: You absorb 50% of the Magicka from incoming spells for 60 seconds

Racial Abilities: 25% Magic Resistance

Ideal Play Style: Mage (Defensive)



A male Breton

A female Breton

Bretons feel an instinctive bond with the mercurial forces of magic and the supernatural. Many great sorcerers have come from their home province of High Rock. In addition to their quick and perceptive grasp of spellcraft, enchantment, and alchemy, all Bretons boast a resistance to spells.

TIP Bretons are fantastic at taking on other mages; both Dragonskin and Magic Resistance support this and are strong abilities even in the late game.

Magic Resistance significantly increases your survivability against enemy casters, while Dragonskin is great at keeping your Magicka up; this helps you maintain the Ward spells that are your first line of defense.



The Elder Scrolls V

SKYRIM

TRAINING: CHARACTER CREATION

PRIMA OFFICIAL GAME GUIDE

WWW.PRIMAGAMES.COM

Dark Elf

Favored Skills: +10 Destruction, +5 Alteration, Illusion, Sneak, Light Armor, Alchemy

Starting Spells: Flames, Sparks, Healing

Racial Power—Ancestor's Wrath: Creates a Flame Cloak that does 10 damage to nearby foes for 60 seconds.

Racial Abilities: 50% Fire Resistance

Ideal Play Style: Nightblade (Mage/Thief)



A male Dark Elf

A female Dark Elf

In the empire, "Dark Elves" is the common usage, but in their Morrowind homeland, they call themselves the "Dunmer." The dark-skinned, red-eyed Dunmer combine powerful intellect with strong and agile physiques, producing superior warriors and sorcerers. On the battlefield, Dark Elves are noted for their skilled and balanced integration of swordsmen, marksmen, and war wizards.

TIP Ancestor's Wrath is a weaker version of Flame Cloak, an Adept-level Destruction spell. While good at early levels—where you're likely to be in melee a lot—it's less valuable once you can cast the spell on your own. It's also less useful if you plan to play a ranged character, such as an archer or pure mage.

Fire Resistance is helpful against Flame Atronachs, fire-wielding casters, and fire-breathing dragons. No one enemy type uses fire spells, so it's hard to predict when exactly this ability will come into play—it's not really something you can use strategically.

High Elf

Favored Skills: +10 Illusion, +5 Alteration, Conjuration, Destruction, Restoration, Enchanting

Starting Spells: Flames, Fury, Healing

Racial Power—Highborn: For 60 seconds, you regenerate 25% of your maximum Magicka each second

Racial Abilities: Highborn Magicka (+50 Magicka)

Ideal Play Style: Mage (Offensive)



A male High Elf

A female High Elf

The High Elves, or Altmer, are the proud, tall, golden-skinned people of Summerset Isle. The common tongue of the empire, Tamrielic, is based on their speech and writing, and most of the empire's arts, crafts, and sciences are derived from High Elven traditions. High Elves are the driving force behind the rising Aldmeri Dominion, and their agents, the Thalmor, are bitterly resented by the Nords of Skyrim.

TIP Highborn will rapidly refill your Magicka, allowing you to continue casting when you need it most. Extremely strong at any level, this power is a mage's lifeline.

Highborn Magicka is like getting five free levels. It's a powerful head start for any mage—you may never need to fall back on your melee skills.

Imperial

Favored Skills: +10 Restoration, +5 Destruction, Enchanting, One-Handed, Block, Heavy Armor

Starting Spells: Flames, Healing

Racial Power—Voice of the Emperor: Calms nearby people for 60 seconds

Racial Abilities: Imperial Luck (adds a small amount of gold to most containers)

Ideal Play Style: Battlemage (Mage/Warrior)



A male Imperial

A female Imperial

Natives of the civilized, cosmopolitan province of Cyrodiil, Imperials are well educated and well spoken. Though physically less imposing than the other races, Imperials are shrewd diplomats and traders. These traits, along with their remarkable skill and training as light infantry, have allowed them to rule an empire that spans the continent for centuries.

TIP Voice of the Emperor is a weaker version of the Expert-level Illusion spell Pacify, with the effect centered on your position. This can be powerful if you're surrounded by a mob of enemies, but it's less useful against smaller groups or ranged foes.

Imperial Luck adds a few extra coins to most of the chests you find. While this bonus is small (10 or less), it adds up over time. But there are plenty of other ways to make money in Skyrim.

Khajiit

Favored Skills: +10 Sneak, +5 Lockpicking, Pickpocket, Alchemy, One-Handed, Archery
Starting Spells: Flames, Healing
Racial Power—Night Eye: Improved night vision for 60 seconds
Racial Abilities: Claws (4x unarmed damage)
Ideal Play Style: Thief (Offensive)



A male Khajiit

A female Khajiit

Khajiit hail from the province of Elsweyr and can vary in appearance from nearly Elven to the Cathay-raht "jaguar men" to the great Senche-Tiger. The most common breed, the Suthay-raht, is intelligent, quick, and agile. Many Khajiit disdain weapons in favor of their claws. They make excellent thieves due to their natural agility and deft hands.

TIP Night Eye allows you to see clearly in dark environments without the need for a light source that might expose your presence. This is occasionally useful, but there's usually enough light in dungeons that you can get by without it. Unlike most powers, Night Eye can be used multiple times a day without restriction.

Claws give you an overwhelming advantage in unarmed combat and brawls. Coupled with the Heavy Armor perk Fists of Steel or appropriate gear, this ability can help unarmed combat remain viable longer. But remember that unarmed combat isn't a skill, it doesn't give you skill uses, and it won't help you level up. Usually it comes into play only in the occasional brawl. But if you're a dedicated role-player who really wants to box your way through Skyrim, well, this is the ability for you.

Nord

Favored Skills: +10 Two-Handed, +5 One-Handed, Block, Smithing, Speech, Light Armor
Starting Spells: Flames, Healing
Racial Power—Battle Cry: All nearby foes flee for 30 seconds
Racial Abilities: 50% Frost Resistance
Ideal Play Style: Warrior (Offensive)



A male Nord

A female Nord

The natives of Skyrim are a tall and fair-haired people, aggressive and fearless in war, industrious and enterprising in trade and exploration. Strong, willful, and hardy, Nords are famous for their resistance to cold, even magical frost. Violence is an accepted and time-honored part of Nordic culture. Nords face battle with an ecstatic ferocity that shocks and appalls their enemies.

TIP Battle Cry is a weaker version of the Master-level Illusion spell Hysteria. Good against a swarm of weak foes, it buys you a few seconds to recover, reposition, or run before the fight resumes. It is useful in the right situation, though it rarely helps you win a fight outright.

Frost Resistance is good against Frost Atronachs, frost-wielding wizards, and frost dragons. But it's at its best in Skyrim's many tombs and crypts, where the undead Draugr wield frost spells almost exclusively.

Orc

Favored Skills: +10 Heavy Armor, +5 Smithing, One-Handed, Two-Handed, Block, Enchanting
Starting Spells: Flames, Healing
Racial Power—Berserk: For 60 seconds, you take half damage and inflict double damage in melee combat
Racial Abilities: None
Ideal Play Style: Warrior (Defensive)



A male Orc

A female Orc

These sophisticated barbarians of the Wrothgarian and Dragontail Mountains are noted for their unshakeable courage in war and their unflinching endurance of hardships. In the past, Orcs have been widely feared and hated by the other nations and races of Tamriel, but they have slowly won acceptance in the empire. Orcish armorers are prized for their craftsmanship, and Orc warriors in heavy armor are among the finest front-line troops in the empire.

TIP Berserk is the Orcs' only racial ability, but it's worth it—for one minute, you become an unstoppable force of destruction. Great in any combat situation, from fending off a swarm of smaller enemies to taking on a powerful dragon, and strong at any level.



The Elder Scrolls V

SKYRIM

TRAINING: CHARACTER CREATION

PRIMA OFFICIAL GAME GUIDE

WWW.PRIMAGAMES.COM

Redguard

Favored Skills: +10 One-Handed, +5 Archery, Block, Smithing, Destruction, Alteration
Starting Spells: Flames, Healing
Racial Power—Adrenaline Rush: You regenerate Stamina 10x faster for 60 seconds
Racial Abilities: 50% Poison Resistance
Ideal Play Style: Spellsworn (Warrior/Mage), Dual-Wielding

The most naturally talented warriors in Tamriel, the dark-skinned, wiry-haired Redguards of Hammerfell seem born to battle, though their pride and fierce independence of spirit makes them more suitable as scouts, skirmishers, or free-ranging heroes and adventurers than as rank-and-file soldiers. Redguards are uniquely versatile combatants, capable of switching between bow, sword, spell, or shield at will and adapting their tactics to the battle at hand.



A male Redguard

A female Redguard

TIP Adrenaline Rush is the Stamina version of Histskin or Highborn. Although less broadly useful than Health or Magicka regen, it will allow you to keep up your power attacks in a protracted battle—or sprint away if necessary.

Poison Resistance is helpful against the few enemies that use poison—Forsworn, Falmer, Chaurus, and spiders—and the rare poison gas trap. Not as broadly useful as most other abilities.

Wood Elf

Favored Skills: +10 Archery, +5 Sneak, Lockpicking, Pickpocket, Light Armor, Alchemy
Starting Spells: Flames, Healing
Racial Power—Command Animal: Target animal becomes your ally for 60 seconds
Racial Abilities: 50% Disease and Poison Resistance
Ideal Play Style: Thief (Archer)

The clanfolk of the Western Valenwood forests. In the empire, they are called “Wood Elves,” but they call themselves the Bosmer, or the “Tree-Sap” people. Wood Elves are nimble and quick in body and wit. Their curious natures and natural agility make them good scouts, agents, and thieves, and there are no finer archers in all of Tamriel.



A male Wood Elf

A female Wood Elf

TIP Command Animal is a powerful, single-target version of the Animal Allegiance Shout. Its main restriction is that it works only on animals. It is good outdoors or in animal dens and caves, but not in most dungeons.

Poison and Disease Resistance is a combined version of the Argonian's Disease Resistance and the Redguard's Poison Resistance abilities. Like them, it can be useful in some situations, but it just isn't a factor most of the time.





This section is arguably the most important in terms of character development. It details every skill and perk in the game and offers advice on what perks to take based on your play style. Remember: You are what you play. You can develop any skill you want, at any time. Don't ever feel locked in to a specific path just because you've focused on it in the past.



SKILLS OVERVIEW



Skill Effects

There are 18 skills in Skyrim, divided into three major sets: Combat, Magic, and Stealth. As each skill increases, its primary effect improves; you also gain access to perks in that skill that can grant you powerful new abilities or bonuses. What does each skill do? Their primary effects are listed below:

COMBAT SKILLS: THE PATH OF MIGHT

✓ SKILL NAME	PRIMARY EFFECT(S)
Smithing	Improves the value and properties of items you improve.
Heavy Armor	Reduces the damage you take while wearing heavy armor.
Block	Reduces the damage you take and the amount you stagger when blocking attacks.
Two-Handed	Increases the damage you inflict with two-handed weapons.
One-Handed	Increases the damage you inflict with one-handed weapons.
Archery	Increases the damage you inflict with bows.

STEALTH SKILLS: THE PATH OF SHADOW

✓ SKILL NAME	PRIMARY EFFECT(S)
Light Armor	Reduces the damage you take while wearing light armor.
Sneak	Improves your ability to avoid detection while sneaking.
Lockpicking	Increases your ability to pick a lock successfully. Specifically, this skill increases the arc at which the pick succeeds and reduces the chance that a pick will break.
Pickpocket	Increases the chance that you can successfully pickpocket an item.
Speech	Improves the prices you receive when buying or selling items, and improves your success at (Persuade), (Bribe), and (Intimidate) dialogue challenges.
Alchemy	Improves the potency of potions and poisons that you craft.

MAGIC SKILLS: THE PATH OF SORCERY

✓ SKILL NAME	PRIMARY EFFECT(S)
Illusion	Reduces the cost of Illusion spells.
Conjuration	Reduces the cost of Conjuration spells.
Destruction	Reduces the cost of Destruction spells.
Restoration	Reduces the cost of Restoration spells.
Alteration	Reduces the cost of Alteration spells.
Enchanting	Improves the potency of items you enchant.

Improving Skills: Skill Use

In the *Elder Scrolls*, you are what you play. In Skyrim, your skill growth and level progression are determined by Skill Uses, a system that tracks the actions you perform and increases your skills accordingly. You don't have to understand how this works—just play the way you want to play, and you'll get better at it. But if you're the kind of adventurer who wants to know everything you can to maximize your potential, read on.

What Are Skill Uses?

Each of the 18 skills is "watching" for particular events to occur in the game. When one of those events occurs, the skill gains points based on the event's magnitude. What magnitude actually means varies by event and is explained in more detail below.

When the number of points in a skill passes a threshold, the skill increases. These thresholds are ever-increasing, so raising a skill from 40 to 41 takes more uses and/or higher-magnitude uses than raising that same skill from 20 to 21.

Each time a skill increases, it also contributes points toward your character's next level. The number of points depends on the level of the skill that increased, so raising a skill from 40 to 41 will take you further toward your next level than raising a skill from 20 to 21. It's important to remember two key rules:

1. Your skills improve only if you use them effectively. For example:

- ✦ Just swinging your sword around doesn't improve your One-Handed skill. However, hitting someone with it does.
- ✦ Just summoning an Atronach over and over again doesn't improve your Conjuration skill. But using the Atronach in combat does.
- ✦ Just talking to everyone you meet doesn't improve your Speech skill. You have to actually buy and sell items and pass dialogue challenges.

2. Your skills generally improve faster if you use them in more challenging situations. For example:

- ✦ Your Archery skill improves faster if you use more powerful bows that do more damage.
- ✦ Your Illusion skill improves faster if you cast more difficult spells.
- ✦ Your Lockpicking skill improves faster if you unlock harder chests.

Improving Skills: Training

During your journey, you will occasionally meet someone who has dedicated their lives to mastering a particular skill. These are extremely talented individuals; speak to them to request training from them in their specialty skill. Most will be happy to oblige...for a price. Each Trainer has a degree of competence—Journeyman, Expert, or Master:

Journeyman Trainers can improve your skill to a maximum of 50.

Expert Trainers can improve your skill to a maximum of 75.

Master Trainers can improve your skill to a maximum of 90.

Even the most proficient Trainers in Skyrim cannot train you past 90. You'll have to earn your way to 100!

The cost to train in a skill is based on your current skill level—the Trainer's skill has no effect. However, the Expert and Master Trainers are often members of a faction and will train you only if you're a member in good standing. Joining a faction is usually easy, so if you want access to a particular Trainer (or set of Trainers), it's worth doing early even if you don't plan to pursue that faction's quests right away.



Read more about our favorite skills and their bonuses at www.primagames.com/SkyrimLegendary



When working with a Trainer, you will receive one skill increase each time you train. You can repeat this up to five times with any combination of Trainers before you must level up. You can then return to any Trainer and pay for up to five more skill points. If you gain a level while training, go level up, then speak to the Trainer again if you want to train more.

An Example: Maximizing Your Training



Runil is happy to teach you his knowledge of Conjuration. For a price.

You wish to improve your Conjuration skill (which is 20), so you visit Runil—the Journeyman Trainer—at the graveyard in Falkreath. He offers to train you for 250 gold. Train with him, and you exchange the gold for one skill point. You can train with him four more times this level, at a slightly higher cost each time. When you're done, your skill is now 25 and you've spent a total of 1,350 gold. You must now level up before you can pay to train again. You could have received the same training from Phinis Gestor (College of Winterhold) or Falion (in Morthal) or any combination of these three, but you could never have trained your skill above 25.

If you're focused on increasing your favorite skills, be sure to visit their Trainers often, ideally just after you level up. For best results, train and then use the skill to help increase it as quickly as possible. Remember that you can visit a variety of Trainers to increase multiple skills!

Some Trainers can also be Followers, and a few of them are even candidates for marriage!

LEGENDARY DIFFICULTY AND SKILLS

Game Difficulty

Skyrim has six difficulty settings: Novice, Apprentice, Adept, Expert, Master, and Legendary. The default difficulty is Adept. The difficulty level modifies how damage is dealt in the game, as shown in the following table:

SKYRIM TABLE OF DIFFICULTY

✓ DIFFICULTY	DAMAGE RECEIVED BY THE PLAYER	DAMAGE RECEIVED BY OTHER CHARACTERS
☐ Novice	x0.5	x2
☐ Apprentice	x0.75	x1.5
☐ Adept	x1	x1
☐ Expert	x1.5	x0.75
☐ Master	x2	x0.5
☐ Legendary	x3	x0.25

What does this mean exactly? Well, think of the following example: While playing on Novice difficulty, you take only half damage from enemy attacks, and your attacks do double damage to your foes. This compares to Adept (the default difficulty).

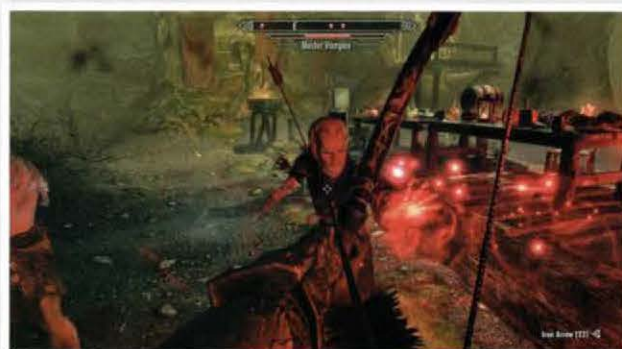
The difficulty level affects only those two statistics. It doesn't affect the difficulty of any other challenges you may face (speech challenges, locks, etc.), and it doesn't affect the rewards you receive (such as perks or loot).

You can change the difficulty at any time in the Gameplay Settings menu (even during combat!). If you feel that the game is becoming too easy (or difficult) for you, don't hesitate to make the switch.



Are the monstrous denizens of Skyrim proving too difficult to defeat? Then reduce your difficulty for fewer fraught confrontations.

Legendary Survivor



Need a challenge? Then bump up your difficulty to Legendary and face down a formidable foe!

Here are some plans for surviving on Skyrim's hardest difficulty setting: Legendary. These strategies apply to Master and Expert difficulty as well, though they may be less critical there.

For about the first ten levels, many foes will be able to kill you in a single hit. Even getting near them is dangerous, since they may perform a kill move you can't dodge. Keep your distance and use ranged attacks to wear them down.

Followers are critical to your survival. Because your Followers are actually taking less damage than normal on Legendary, they can withstand a barrage of attacks that would easily fell you. During the initial events in Helgen, stay behind your ally (Hadvar or Ralof). After making your escape, recruit a defensive, melee-focused Follower, like Vorstag, Lydia, or Farkas, and let them hold the enemy's attention while you strike from range.

Seek out additional companions whenever the opportunity presents itself. Recruit a dog, like Vigilance in Markarth or one of the Dawnguard huskies. Pick up the Conjure Familiar or Conjure Flame Atronach spells for a summoned ally. Quests that give you short-term or long-term Followers, like the Dawnguard Main Quest (Serana) or Daedric Quest: A Daedra's Best Friend (Barbas), are also worth doing early.

Defense is the best offense. Decide which armor skill you plan to use and stick to it. Focus on raising that skill, taking perks in it as soon as they become available (especially perks that increase your Armor Rating) and augmenting it with enchantments and potions. Look for other opportunities to increase your defense as well. The Lord Stone's Damage Reduction and Magic Resistance bonuses are a great asset, as are potions or enchantments that increase your other resistances.

Crowd-control abilities are much more valuable in *Legendary*—you simply can't survive being attacked by multiple foes at once. The Nord racial power *Battle Cry* is ideal for this purpose, especially early in your adventure. Illusion spells like *Fear* and *Calm* can remove a single enemy from the fight, while Shouts like *Animal Allegiance*, *Kyne's Peace*, *Dismaying Shout*, and *Slow Time* will help fend off larger groups. In *Beast Form*, the werewolf's *Fear Howl* is also very effective.

Survey the battlefield and use the terrain to your advantage. Snipe your enemies from a distance or a different elevation and force them to come to you. Maintain that distance by backing away as you continue your assault.

Early on, you may be tempted to focus on noncombat or crafting skills in order to gain some quick levels. Resist that temptation. As your level increases, the foes you face become stronger as well. If you neglect your combat skills, you may fall even further behind.

That said, don't neglect your support skills forever. If you can survive the first few levels, gradually investing in skills like *Smithing*, *Enchanting*, and *Alchemy* can help you gain an edge later on.

Scour the Training section of this guide for tips and advice, and take it to heart. Many tips that are only useful on a lower difficulty level—like getting "free" healing by leveling up when your health is low—are absolutely essential to your survival.

▶ Legendary Skills



Need to be written about in Nord sagas of yore? Then truly master a skill (such as Archery) by taking it to Legendary status...and beyond!

Once one of your skills reaches 100, it cannot increase any further. You can continue to use it, taking advantage of your mastery of the skill (and its high-level perks, if you choose to acquire them). However, because you gain levels based on skill increases, continuing to use this skill will not help you progress toward the next level. Eventually, once all of your skills reach 100, you will no longer be able to gain levels at all.

When one of your skills reaches 100, a new option will appear when you highlight its constellation on the Skills menu: *Legendary*. To make that skill *Legendary*, press the *Legendary* button and confirm your choice. Several things will then happen:

The skill will be marked as *Legendary* (an icon appears below the skill).

The skill will be reset from 100 to 15.

Any perks that you had in the skill will be refunded.

In effect, the *Legendary* skill system allows you to start over again with a skill. You can continue using it, work your way back up to 100, and gain levels as you do so (because the skill is increasing). If you reach 100, you can choose to roll it over again. This allows you to continue gaining levels and amassing perk points indefinitely!

If you reset a skill multiple times, a number will appear next to the *Legendary* icon below that skill, recording how many times you have reached 100 with it.

Each new level is increasingly difficult to attain, so even with multiple *Legendary* skills, you shouldn't expect to acquire every possible perk. Note that *Legendary* skills are not better than non-*Legendary* skills—the *Legendary* designation simply recognizes that you had mastered the skill and chose to start over with it again.

▶ Legendary Skills: General Advice



Crafting the finest armor with the most impressive enchantments, and then reset your Smithing and Enchantment skills; you can still use the fruits of your labor.

Legendary skills are not for everyone. The Skill 100 perks are entertaining and powerful and reward you for the effort it took to master their skill in the first place. Try them out. Don't be too quick to throw away the chance to forge *Dragonbone* Armor, craft the perfect potion, or call upon a *Blizzard* to devastate your foes. Even without *Legendary* skills, you can still reach a very high level (80+), and you can always choose to make a skill *Legendary* later on.

While you can make a skill *Legendary* at any time, if you're sure you want to reset a particular skill, it's generally best to do so as soon as it reaches 100. Otherwise, you may be throwing away skill uses that could have counted toward your next level.

There is one exception to that rule: If a skill can provide you with an ongoing benefit even after you've reset it, make sure to take advantage of it. For example, use your *Smithing* skill to forge and improve a complete set (or two) of *Dragonbone* or *Daedric* weapons and armor. Once you reset your *Smithing* skill, you'll be back to working with iron weapons and armor again—but you can continue to use anything you previously crafted.

Similarly, use your *Enchanting* skill to enchant your best gear before you reset it, and use *Alchemy* to stockpile a collection of powerful potions or poisons. While you won't lose any enchantments or recipes you've learned when you reset a skill, it will be a while before you can make anything as powerful again.

The Master-level *Conjuration* spells allow you to permanently summon (or create) *Thralls*. These spells are powerful but are prohibitively costly without the Skill 100 Master *Conjuration* perk. Before you reset your *Conjuration* skill, make sure to summon a *Thrall* (or two, if you have the *Twin Souls* perk). They'll continue to follow you even after you've reset your *Conjuration* skill.

Some skills, especially crafting skills, can be relatively easy to build up again...if you're prepared. If your skill is approaching 100 and you plan to reset it, take some time to collect low-level raw materials like *Iron Ore*, *Dwarven Scrap*, *Petty* and *Lesser Soul Gems*, unenchanted weapons and armor, and loose ingredients you can craft with after the reset. If you plan to reset *Speech*, this is a great time to do it, since these crafting sessions will produce a large number of low-level items to sell.

Don't reset too many skills at once—make sure you still have enough high-level skills to be successful in combat. Otherwise, you may find yourself lowering the difficulty just to survive.

When you reset a skill, it helps to have a high-level skill of a similar type that you can fall back on while you work your old skill back up to 100. For example, before resetting an offensive skill (*One Handed*, *Two Handed*, *Archery*, *Destruction*, *Conjuration*), make sure you have another offensive skill at 50+ in case you find yourself in need of more attack power. Similarly, before resetting a defensive skill (*Heavy Armor*, *Light Armor*, *Alteration*, *Restoration*), make sure you have a second defensive skill ready to help you mitigate or recover from damage.

Save first. When you reset a skill, your character will suddenly become much less powerful. You may find it surprisingly difficult to cope with the loss of a combat, armor, or support skill you've come to rely on, especially if you don't have an appropriate backup skill. Since this is one choice you can't undo, make sure you have a save you can fall back on, just in case.



The Elder Scrolls V

SKYRIM

TRAINING PART 1

PRIMA OFFICIAL GAME GUIDE

WWW.PRIMAGAMES.COM